All afternoon she sat, weaving coconut mats and thinking about her dream. That night, Iniya heard her parents whisper as the oil lamp burned deep into the night.

The next morning, her father gave her a smaller basket.

"How can we carry all the fish in this little basket?" Iniya asked.

"We will only take as many fish as will fit inside this basket," he replied.

Iniya was puzzled. "How will this be enough for us?" Iniya wondered.

When she came back from school, she was happy to find her mother making soap and oil from the coconuts.

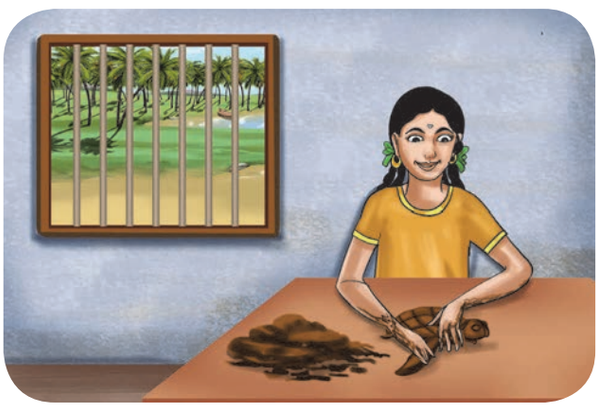




Iniya swiftly climbed up a tree to get more coconuts, but her mother said, "Don't pluck them! We must only use what the tree gives us.".

Her father said, "We have taken only fallen coconuts for making these things. Look, we've even made this soap with a jasmine flower inside!"

Iniya learnt a lot about gardening and arts at school. When Iniya grew older, she made coconut fibre packs that could be used to pot plants. She also loved to carve coconuts. She made many toys and idols with fallen coconuts. Her favourite was to carve tiny turtles out of coconut shells. She always wore one around her neck.



Note to the teacher: Read the story to the children. Encourage them to know the name of the tree and its uses.

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